

Ch 3: Water Resources

Question Bank | 2M | 3M | 5M

SECTION A - 2 MARKS

Q1. Explain three reasons why water scarcity exists even in water-abundant regions of India. (PYQ 2013)

Q2. How has urbanisation added to water scarcity in India? Explain with three points. (PYQ 2019)

Q3. Explain the advantages of multipurpose river projects. (PYQ — frequently asked)

Q4. Explain three disadvantages of multipurpose river projects in India. (PYQ 2018)

Q5. "Multipurpose projects have failed to achieve the purpose for which they were built." Justify with three reasons. (PYQ 2014)

Q6. Explain three ways in which multipurpose projects and large dams have created conflicts among people. (PYQ)

Q7. Explain any three ways in which irrigation schemes have changed the social landscape of India. (PYQ 2012)

Q8. Why is rooftop rainwater harvesting important in Rajasthan? Explain three reasons. (PYQ 2013, 2014)

Q9. Read the given source on Rainwater Harvesting and answer: What is water harvesting? Why is it considered a viable alternative to multipurpose projects? (PYQ 2023 source-based)

Q10. Explain how water harvesting is a viable alternative both socio-economically and environmentally to multipurpose projects. (PYQ 2013)

Q11. Explain how intensive industrialisation and urbanisation have put pressure on freshwater resources in India. Give two examples each. (PYQ 2012)

Q12. Describe the different types of hydraulic structures constructed in ancient India with examples. (PYQ)

Q13. How was water conserved in ancient India? Give three examples. (PYQ 2012)

Q14. Explain three social impacts of multipurpose river projects on local communities.

Q15. How have multipurpose projects changed the cropping pattern and social landscape of regions in India? (PYQ 2012)

Q16. Explain three reasons why different water harvesting techniques developed in different regions of India.

Q17. Describe any three traditional water harvesting methods practised in India with examples from different regions.

Q18. Explain how dams affect the natural flow of rivers and harm aquatic life. Give three points. (PYQ 2018)

Q19. Explain three causes of water scarcity in India — population, agriculture, and industries.

Q20. Describe the functioning of the rooftop rainwater harvesting system in Rajasthan. How is water stored and used?

Q21. Explain the Narmada Bachao Andolan. What issues did it raise? What was its impact? (PYQ)

Q22. How do inter-state water disputes arise from multipurpose projects? Give two examples from India.

Q23. Explain three environmental consequences of building large dams on rivers.

Q24. How has irrigation contributed to ecological consequences like salinization? Explain three points.

Q25. Explain how dams created during the first century BC in Allahabad and during Chandragupta Maurya's time show India's tradition of water conservation.

Q26. Explain any three reasons why groundwater levels are falling rapidly in urban and agricultural areas of India.

Q27. How does the unequal distribution of water resources contribute to water scarcity? Explain with examples from India.

Q28. Explain the concept of sustainable water management. Why is it necessary for India?

Q29. Describe the bamboo drip irrigation system used in Meghalaya. What are its advantages?

Q30. Explain how floods and droughts are both linked to poor water management in India.

Q31. Explain how multipurpose projects benefited some sections of society while harming others. Who gained and who lost?

Q32. How do rivers in India turn into toxic streams? What are the consequences for human health and ecology?

Q33. Describe the water harvesting techniques used in the flood plains of Bengal, Western Himalayas, and semi-arid Rajasthan.

Q34. Explain three reasons why water harvesting systems developed in ancient India are still relevant today.

Q35. How does growing population lead to increased water demand and eventual water scarcity? Explain three links.

Q36. Explain why sedimentation in reservoirs is a serious problem. How does it affect the functioning of dams?

Q37. Describe three ways in which water scarcity can be addressed without building large dams.

Q38. Explain how agricultural overuse of water for commercial crops has led to groundwater depletion in Punjab and Haryana.

Q39. Describe the role of the government in ensuring sustainable water management in India. Give three examples.

Q40. Why is the hydrological cycle important for maintaining freshwater availability on earth? Explain three points.

Q41. How has the Sabarmati basin conflict between urban and agricultural water use become an example of water disputes in India?

Q42. Explain three ways in which rainwater harvesting can reduce dependence on river water and groundwater in India.

Q43. Describe the water conservation tradition of ancient India with reference to two specific structures and their locations.

SECTION B - 3 MARKS

Q1. Explain the advantages and disadvantages of multipurpose river projects in India. (PYQ — *most repeated*)

Q2. "Multipurpose projects and large dams have come under great scrutiny and opposition in recent years." Explain with five reasons. (PYQ 2018)

Q3. Explain how water harvesting is a viable alternative to multipurpose river projects both socio-economically and environmentally. (PYQ 2013)

Q4. "Urbanisation has added greatly to water scarcity in India." Support this statement with five arguments. (PYQ 2019)

Q5. Describe the various traditional water harvesting techniques practised in different regions of India. Explain how they are suited to local conditions.

Q6. Read the source on Narmada Bachao Andolan and answer: What is it? Against which project was it launched? What issues did it originally and later focus on? Who were involved? What was its impact? (PYQ — source-based)

Q7. How did multipurpose projects change the cropping pattern, social landscape, and ecological conditions of river valleys in India? Explain with five points. (PYQ 2012)

Q8. Explain five causes of water scarcity in India. How can water management help address them?

Q9. Describe the history of water conservation in ancient India. Give five examples of hydraulic structures and their locations. (PYQ 2012)

Q10. Explain why freshwater is becoming scarce despite three-fourths of the earth being covered with water. Discuss five reasons with reference to India.

Q11. "Dams were considered temples of modern India but have also become centres of conflict." Explain both sides of this statement with five points each.

Q12. Explain the functioning and significance of rooftop rainwater harvesting. How has it been implemented differently in Rajasthan and Tamil Nadu?

Q13. How have industrialisation, population growth, and urbanisation together placed enormous pressure on India's freshwater resources? Explain with five examples.

Q14. Explain the environmental consequences of building large dams on rivers. How do they affect river ecology, aquatic life, and local communities?

Q15. "Water harvesting systems are more sustainable and community-friendly than large multipurpose projects." Do you agree? Justify with five points.

Q16. Explain the concept of sustainable water management. What steps can individuals, communities, and the government take to conserve water in India?

Q17. Describe the working of the Narmada Bachao Andolan. Why did it begin? Who were involved? What were the short-term and long-term outcomes?

Q18. How do inter-state water disputes arise in India? Explain with reference to the Krishna-Godavari dispute and the Sabarmati basin conflict.

Q19. Explain how India's ancient tradition of water harvesting — from the Chandragupta Maurya era to the 14th century — reflects sophisticated understanding of water conservation.

Q20. Describe five ecological and social problems caused by the construction of large dams in India. What alternative approaches can be considered?

Q21. How is rainwater harvesting practised in different parts of India? Describe techniques used in Rajasthan, Bengal, Western Himalayas, and Meghalaya with five examples.

Q22. "The benefits of multipurpose projects are not shared equally." Discuss who benefits and who suffers from large dam projects in India with five points.

Q23. Explain the meaning and importance of water as a resource. Why is freshwater scarce and what steps has India taken to manage it sustainably?

Q24. How has India's growing demand for food led to over-exploitation of water resources? Explain the link between agriculture, irrigation, and water scarcity with five points.

Q25. Explain the significance of the hydrological cycle in maintaining the availability of freshwater on earth. How does human interference disrupt this cycle?

Q26. Describe the role of traditional communities and local knowledge systems in water conservation across different regions of India. Give five examples.

SECTION C - 5 MARKS

Q1. Explain the advantages and disadvantages of multipurpose river projects in India. (PYQ — *most repeated*)

Q2. "Multipurpose projects and large dams have come under great scrutiny and opposition in recent years." Explain with five reasons. (PYQ 2018)

Q3. Explain how water harvesting is a viable alternative to multipurpose river projects both socio-economically and environmentally. (PYQ 2013)

Q4. "Urbanisation has added greatly to water scarcity in India." Support this statement with five arguments. (PYQ 2019)

Q5. Describe the various traditional water harvesting techniques practised in different regions of India. Explain how they are suited to local conditions.

Q6. Read the source on Narmada Bachao Andolan and answer: What is it? Against which project was it launched? What issues did it originally and later focus on? Who were involved? What was its impact? (PYQ — *source-based*)

Q7. How did multipurpose projects change the cropping pattern, social landscape, and ecological conditions of river valleys in India? Explain with five points. (PYQ 2012)

Q8. Explain five causes of water scarcity in India. How can water management help address them?

Q9. Describe the history of water conservation in ancient India. Give five examples of hydraulic structures and their locations. (PYQ 2012)

Q10. Explain why freshwater is becoming scarce despite three-fourths of the earth being covered with water. Discuss five reasons with reference to India.

Q11. "Dams were considered temples of modern India but have also become centres of conflict." Explain both sides of this statement with five points each.

Q12. Explain the functioning and significance of rooftop rainwater harvesting. How has it been implemented differently in Rajasthan and Tamil Nadu?

Q13. How have industrialisation, population growth, and urbanisation together placed enormous pressure on India's freshwater resources? Explain with five examples.

Q14. Explain the environmental consequences of building large dams on rivers. How do they affect river ecology, aquatic life, and local communities?

Q15. "Water harvesting systems are more sustainable and community-friendly than large multipurpose projects." Do you agree? Justify with five points.

Q16. Explain the concept of sustainable water management. What steps can individuals, communities, and the government take to conserve water in India?

Q17. Describe the working of the Narmada Bachao Andolan. Why did it begin? Who were involved? What were the short-term and long-term outcomes?

Q18. How do inter-state water disputes arise in India? Explain with reference to the Krishna-Godavari dispute and the Sabarmati basin conflict.

Q19. Explain how India's ancient tradition of water harvesting — from the Chandragupta Maurya era to the 14th century — reflects sophisticated understanding of water conservation.

Q20. Describe five ecological and social problems caused by the construction of large dams in India. What alternative approaches can be considered?

Q21. How is rainwater harvesting practised in different parts of India? Describe techniques used in Rajasthan, Bengal, Western Himalayas, and Meghalaya with five examples.

Q22. "The benefits of multipurpose projects are not shared equally." Discuss who benefits and who suffers from large dam projects in India with five points.

Q23. Explain the meaning and importance of water as a resource. Why is freshwater scarce and what steps has India taken to manage it sustainably?

Q24. How has India's growing demand for food led to over-exploitation of water resources? Explain the link between agriculture, irrigation, and water scarcity with five points.

Q25. Explain the significance of the hydrological cycle in maintaining the availability of freshwater on earth. How does human interference disrupt this cycle?

Q26. Describe the role of traditional communities and local knowledge systems in water conservation across different regions of India. Give five examples.